Malta's construction waste: 100% recovered?

The Commission's 2026 Country Report, checked against the JRC and Eurostat

THE CLAIM

> ***"By contrast, the rate of recovery of construction and demolition waste is 100, above the EU average of 89%."***

European Commission, 2026 Country Report – Malta, 3 June 2026

Annex 8 (circular economy), citing a 2024 JRC assessment.

The sentence follows Malta's low municipal and plastic recycling rates.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

Right on the legal measure; most of it was backfilling.

SUPPORTED | **LARGELY SUPPORTED** | NOT SUBSTANTIATED | MISLEADING | CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

100%

Malta, 2020 and 2022

Recovered: all but 12 of 2.95 million tonnes in 2020. The report omits the % sign.

90.9%

EU-27, 2020

Current Eurostat data. The 89% cited is from an older release; 91.4% in 2022.

58%

Backfilling, 2020

Most of Malta's 'recovery' filled excavations such as spent quarries. EU: 12%.

42%

Recycling, 2020

Recycling alone: 21st of 27. It rose to 67% in 2022 (EU 80%).

16 → 100

2010 to 2012

Quarry deposits were reclassified from landfill to backfilling.

FAIR TO SAY

EU law counts backfilling towards its 70% target, so the figure is correct. Recovery is not the same as recycling.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

- ☐ Commission: state the unit and the current EU value.
- ☐ ERA: how quarry deposits meet the backfilling definition.
- ☐ NSO: 2024 tables by operation.
- ☐ No right of reply needed.